

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families

Trikulamaṅgala · Toh 823 · Derge Kangyur

རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་འཕྱི་མཁའ་ལྷ་སྐྱོད་ཀྱི་འཕྱི་མཁའ་ལྷ་སྐྱོད་

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families (Tibetan: Rigs gsum gyi bkra shis) is a short devotional text in verse, composed as a prayer for well-being and good fortune. It invokes the three bodhisattvas who are traditionally regarded as the protectors of the three families, namely Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, and Vajrapāṇi, each of whom is praised as protector of the three worlds. Each stanza pairs one of these figures with the body, speech, or mind of the Sugata, and closes with the wish that, by the auspiciousness of that aspect of the Buddha, there may be well-being here today. The text opens and closes with a rubric that links it to a companion piece, the verses of auspiciousness of the five, and it begins with homage to the Three Jewels. It is Toh 823 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section as one of a group of short auspiciousness verses, and I have not been able to determine a Sanskrit title from the source lines provided.

Here ends the verses of auspiciousness of the five. I pay homage to the Three Jewels.

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families.

The Blessed One, golden in hue, like the king of mountains,
The form of Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, protector of the three worlds:
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the Sugata's body,
By that auspiciousness, may there be well-being here today.

The Blessed One, conch-white in hue, like the king of mountains,
Avalokiteśvara, the sovereign, protector of the three worlds:
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the Sugata's speech,
By that auspiciousness, may there be well-being here today.

The Blessed One, greenish-yellow, like the king of mountains,
Vajrapāṇi, protector of the three worlds:
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the Sugata's mind,
By that auspiciousness too, may there be well-being here today.

Translator's Notes

• The colophon-like opening line, "Here ends the verses of auspiciousness of the five," belongs to the preceding text and was joined to this one in the source. The color of the third figure,

འཇུག་ལྗང་ལྗང་, is rendered "greenish-yellow." It could also be read as a yellow-green or olive shade. The sugata is the Buddha (the "well-gone one"). In each verse the Blessed One is identified with the body, speech, or mind of the Sugata, and through that with the figure of Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, or Vajrapāṇi, the lords of the three families. The phrase "like the king of mountains" (Mount Meru) is a standard comparison of splendor and stability.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.